

gbareader V1.3

Full controls

Read TXT and EPUB books, save your reading position, and resume later. Place UTF-8 **.txt** and supported **.epub** files directly in **/gbareader** on the SD-card root, then restart the app. It lists up to 64 files, not subfolders, with five books visible at once. A missing or empty folder shows instructions; Controls and Credits remain available. This reader has no text editing, typing or user-facing export controls.

Library

- **Up / Down**: select a **.txt** or **.epub** book
- **A**: open the selected book
- **Select**: show Controls. **Left / Right** changes help pages; **B** returns Home.
- **Start**: show Credits, always beginning with the personal author page. **Left / Right** turns Credits pages; **B** or **Start** returns to the library. Font/framework/license attribution is on subsequent pages.

Reader

- **Right** or **A**: next page
- **Left** or **B**: previous page
- **Down**: open the reader settings
- **Up**: enable or disable shoulder-button page turns for the current session. When enabled, **L** goes to the previous page and **R** goes to the next page. This option starts disabled whenever the app launches and is not saved.
- **Start**: save the current page, reader settings and up to 64 previous page offsets inside the open TXT or EPUB file. A **save...** message appears while writing, followed temporarily by the honest result: **Saved** or **Save failed**.
- **Select**: close the book and return to the library without saving

Current-display-layout bookmarks retain up to 64 previous page offsets. Older or unknown display-layout bookmarks keep their saved byte position but rebuild Back history incrementally, because their glyph widths may differ. An early Back request shows **Loading back...** while reconstruction proceeds.

Settings

- **Up / Down:** select line spacing, top margin or bottom margin
- **Left / Right:** change the selected value
- **B** or **Start:** apply the displayed settings and return to the reader. To retain them in either TXT or EPUB, press **Start** again from the reader. Rows remain 16 pixels high; SuperFW is native 16px and Arabic Ghoulam is native 11px.

Arabic display

Shaping starts off for each document unless its saved flag is on. When off, opening checks only the page being resumed (or the first page). Finding Arabic enables shaping and automatically saves ON inside that document. Future opens retain ON; other files are unaffected. Later pages are not checked in an off-mode session: reopen on a page containing Arabic to enable it. A mode change keeps your reading position but rebuilds incompatible Back history.

When enabled, Arabic joins right-to-left with native 11px Ghoulam; Latin/digits remain left-to-right. Harakat are hidden, never deleted. The row stays 16px. Mixed direction and Persian/Urdu coverage are limited; no typing mode is added.

Files, saving and compatibility

TXT bookmarks are stored in a trailing footer. EPUB bookmarks and normalized text caches stay inside the EPUB as ZIP members. No GBA .sav or permanent settings sidecar is required. Initial EPUB cache preparation and first-time Arabic activation save state automatically. Later position, back history and settings changes require a successful Reader Start save.

An EPUB may show Preparing cache... on first opening. Cache preparation writes inside the EPUB automatically; it is not a text-editing or export feature. Wait for storage operations to finish before switching off. If a save fails, keep the book open and retry; do not assume the new place was stored.

Supported files use UTF-8. EPUB support is text-only: no DRM, images, CSS presentation, scripts, embedded fonts, audio or video. Arabic uses native Ghoulam joining and limited per-line RTL; harakat are hidden only on screen. Full Persian/Urdu and full Unicode bidi are not supported. Long names are clipped on screen, not changed on disk. Missing storage or a missing/empty /gbareader folder never opens a demo or scans the card root.

Requires compatible Supercard SD hardware. Emulator UI checks do not prove physical SD-card operation. Keep backups of your books.

Credits and font licenses

Made by Halim Jarrar

(C) 2026

halim-jarrar.de

monday@halim-jarrar.de

Ghoulam Regular © 2025 Imad AlFil / mloukhiyye, CC BY 4.0. Converted actual contextual GSUB forms to native 11px monochrome ROM glyphs; this modified representation is not author endorsement. Source: <https://mloukhiyye.itch.io/ghoulam-arabic-pixel-art-font-version-1> — License: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>.

SuperFW fonts, renderer and SD foundation: David Guillen Fandos, © 2024–2025, GPL v3 or later. <https://superfw.davidgf.net/>. The original SuperFW and supplemental font packs are unchanged.

UNSCII by Viznut: the included unscii-16-full-derived font pack is GPL, not wholly public domain. It incorporates GNU Unifont and public-domain Fixedsys Excelsior glyphs. <https://viznut.fi/unscii/>.

GNU Unifont / Hangul: Roman Czyborra, Paul Hardy and Unifont contributors. GPL v2 or later with the GNU font embedding exception. <https://www.unifoundry.com/unifont/>. The inherited exact font snapshot version is not recorded; no claim of eligibility for a newer alternative OFL license is made.

Butano engine and UI font: Gustavo Valiente, zlib license. Built with devkitARM / devkitPro. FatFs © 2022 ChaN, permissive redistribution terms in src/ff.c. Framework dependency notices remain in the Butano source distribution.

miniz: MIT license; © 2010–2014 Rich Geldreich and Tenacious Software LLC; © 2013–2014 RAD Game Tools and Valve Software. Complete notice in third_party/miniz/LICENSE.

Based on gba-vocab-trainer-CC v0.2.5. Project license: GPL v3 or later. Full source and notices: <https://github.com/Xinon232/gbareader>. In-ROM Credits keeps the personal block on page one and third-party credits on the following six pages. Left/Right changes pages; B or Start closes.